

Founders

How long have the founders known one another and how did you meet?

Have any of the founders not met in person?

- Both of us are founding engineers (#2 and 4) at Hadrius (YC W23)
- We met about 8 months ago when Jonathan was hired
- We work together 5 days/week in office
- Got to know each other staying late after work and working on side projects

Who writes code, or does other technical work on your product? Was any of it done by a non-founder? Please explain.

All of the code has been written by both of us.

Company

Company name

SmartAppetite

Describe what your company does in 50 characters or less.

AI agents to replace insurance brokers

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

We built an AI agent to help insurance brokers save 15hrs / week by finding the best quotes for their customers across dozens of carriers in seconds.

We do this by using LLMs to read appetite/underwriting guides, past declinations, and public docs, then return a ranked list of carriers likely to say yes, with reasons and confidence. Then our browser extension auto-fills each carrier portal from that single application, tracks submission status, and builds a customer-ready quote comparison.

In the future our product will cover 80%+ of a broker's tasks, handling the lead -> quote -> bind -> renew workflow so agencies can run all their core tasks with our AI agents.

Where do you live now, and where would the company be based after YC?

New York, US / San Francisco, US

Explain your decision regarding location.

SF is the best way for us to

- Be around the top .001% in AI
- Maximize our chance of success

Progress

How far along are you?

- Launched last week working nights and weekends
- 1 signed customer at \$200 MRR
- 3 in pipeline with \$3.5k MRR quoted
- Dozens of customer conversations

--- Update

- Verbal agreement at \$600/mo
- Proposal out at \$1k/mo
- 20+ new convos with agency owners
- 4 demos this week
- MVP for carrier portal automation

How long have each of you been working on this? How much of that has been full-time? Please explain.

We have both been working part-time on SmartAppetite for ~2 months and are leaving Hadrius in a few weeks to focus full-time. The founders already know; we're just closing/handing off some of our work

--- Update

We are full time as of Aug 15th

What tech stack are you using, or planning to use, to build this product? Include AI models and AI coding tools you use.

- Django / Next.js
- o3 / Claude Sonnet/Opus 4 / Gemini 2.5 pro
- Claude code and Cursor for coding and o3 for planning

Are people using your product?

Yes

How many active users or customers do you have? How many are paying?
Who is paying you the most, and how much do they pay you?

1 active customer (2 seats) on a \$200/month contract

Do you have revenue?

Yes

If you are applying with the same idea as a previous batch, did anything change? If you applied with a different idea, why did you pivot and what did you learn from the last idea?

We applied to S25 with Codigami, an AI agent that turns Figma mocks into code. We hadn't talked to any users at all, and once we started, we realized their problem was not acute enough + they already had good options (Cursor, Lovable, V0, etc...).

We learned to talk to customers first and validate three things before building - 1) the pain is frequent and costly, 2) there's a budget for it, and 3) we can build a 10x solution. For SmartAppetite we've been talking to customers since before a single line of code was written

If you have already participated or committed to participate in an incubator, "accelerator" or "pre-accelerator" program, please tell us about it.

N/a

Idea

Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?

We chose this idea because:

- With IIMS we can 10x carrier selection accuracy from unstructured docs (appetite guides, declinations, emails) and kill re-keying via portal automation.
- We know the playbook from a near-identical environment at Hadrius (RIA compliance): fragmented tools, document-heavy workflows, and ROI from automating decision + data entry loops.
- The incumbents are stagnant and software is fragmented; agencies re-enter the same data across point solutions.
- It's a massive market (~39,000 independent P&C agencies in the US; commercial lines are >\$500B and independents place most P&C)

We're talking to as many agencies as we can and building up expertise quickly.

We know people need this because:

- Talked to dozens of agents and owners at agencies
- One agency onboarding Aug 1st

Who are your competitors? What do you understand about your business that they don't?

Our competitors for carrier matching/fit are commercial comparative raters EZLynx (2003; bought by Applied '21), Tarmika (2018; bought by Applied '22), Vertafore PL Rating (#1 PL; Vertafore sold for \$5.35B) They're PE-owned, and built their products pre-AI.

They're inaccurate and don't support all of the insurance carriers agencies use.

They don't understand that:

- Accuracy requires reasoning over unstructured docs (appetite/underwriting guides, declinations, emails, etc...) which can only be done by people or LLMs.
- We can support all of an agencies' carriers on day one by using LLMs - which they can't since they rely on carrier buy-in. We support any carrier an agency already works with because we get the appetite information from the agency, not the carriers.

How do or will you make money? How much could you make?

We have a per-seat subscription model at \$100/seat/month, and are best suited for agencies with 20+ carriers

That's ~14000 agencies in the US at an average of 5 seats - \$6,000 ARR per agency at base pricing and ~\$84M ARR

- As we automate more workflows and capture more of the labor budget, we can serve ~39,000 US P&C agencies at \$20k to \$50k per year, or ~\$0.8B to ~\$1.9B ARR.
- End state is a full Agency OS that automates the whole job. At \$100k-\$200k per agency per year for ~39,000 US P&C agencies, that's ~\$3.9B-\$7.8B ARR.

Which category best applies to your company?

B2B SaaS

If you had any other ideas you considered applying with, please list them. One may be something we've been waiting for. Often when we fund people it's to do something they list here and not in the main application.

We considered AI underwriting triage for commercial submissions on the insurance carriers' side. A lot of applications get declined - carriers' underwriting teams have to manually process thousands of applications, and decide which applications match their appetite and are good business opportunities. LLMs can read the full submission (lots of freeform text, massive pdf

documents) and the carrier's appetite/underwriting guides, then score fit and route to the right underwriter.

Curious

What convinced you to apply to Y Combinator? Did someone encourage you to apply? Have you been to any YC events?

We both work at Hadrius (YC W23) and the founders recommended us to apply

How did you hear about Y Combinator?

Jonathan: Found YC through PG's youtube videos in high school

Mark: A high school robotics coach recommended Hacker News and I've been reading daily since